

A

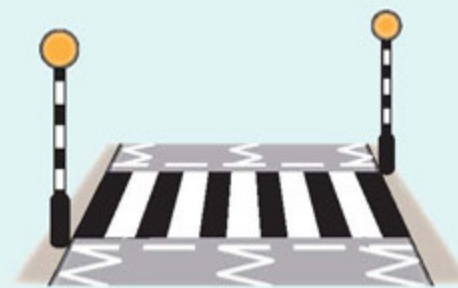
Roads



traffic lights



(road) junction

a **bend** in the road
(this road **bends**
to the right)

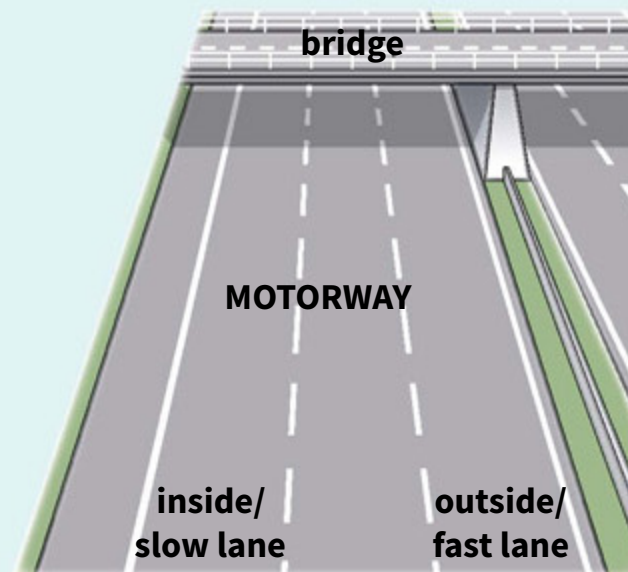
pedestrian crossing



no overtaking

[you can't pass
another car]

speed limit



bridge

MOTORWAY

inside/
slow laneoutside/
fast lane

B

Finding your way

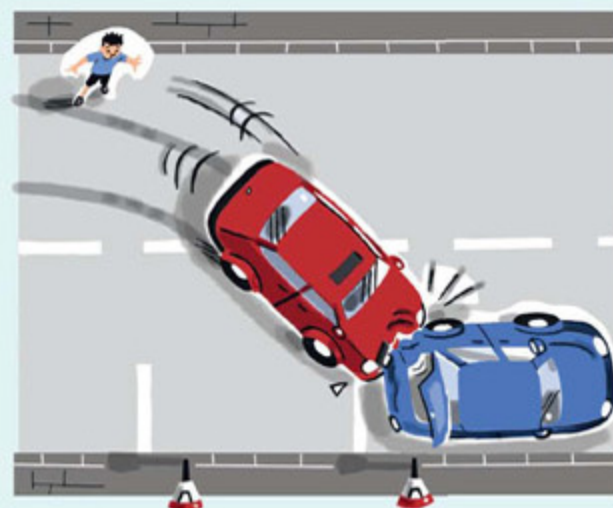
“Yesterday, I **got lost**¹ **on my way to**² the airport. I decided to use side roads and go **via**³ the village of Pensford, but I took the wrong **turning**⁴ just before I got there, and I **ended up**⁵ in a supermarket car park. Fortunately I was able to **ask** someone **the way**⁶, and a very kind woman **directed**⁷ me to the A38, where I could then follow **signs** for the airport.”

¹ didn't know where I was² while I was going to (the airport)³ go through somewhere to get to a destination⁴ corner where one road meets another⁵ found myself in a place I didn't expect to be in⁶ ask how to get to a place⁷ told me how to get to a place

C

An accident

“I saw an **accident** this morning on the **main road**¹ into town. A **pedestrian**² – a young boy – stepped off the **pavement**³ and into the road just as a car was **approaching**⁴. The driver **braked**⁵, but the car **swerved**⁶ and **crashed into** a **parked car**⁷ on the opposite side of the road. Fortunately the driver wasn't **injured** but both cars were quite badly **damaged**.”

¹ important road² a person walking³ the place where pedestrians walk⁴ coming closer⁵ put his foot on the **brake** to stop the car⁶ changed direction suddenly and
without control⁷ a car next to the pavement, not moving

Language help

You **damage** a thing [harm or break it] but **injure** a person [hurt them]. The related nouns are **damage** and **injury**, e.g. *There was a lot of **damage** to the bike, but the cyclist only had minor **injuries**.*

Exercises

29.1 Which words are being defined?

- 1 part of a road that is separated from other parts by a line *lane*
- 2 people who are walking
- 3 the place where people usually walk
- 4 the place where people can cross the road
- 5 the place where two roads meet
- 6 the thing you put your foot on to stop a car
- 7 a message or symbol beside the road that gives information

29.2 Complete the information for these road signs.



1 50 mph *speed*
limit



3



5 end of



7 a
in the road



2 there is only one



4 no



6 low



8

29.3 Rewrite the sentences on the left starting with the words given. Keep a similar meaning.

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1 I asked him how to get to the bank. | I asked him the <i>way</i> to the bank. |
| 2 I didn't know where I was in the town centre. | I got in the town centre. |
| 3 You can ask someone to tell you how to get here. | You can ask someone to you. |
| 4 I went through Ledbury to get to Malvern. | I went to Malvern Ledbury. |
| 5 I was going to the station. | I was on my to the station. |
| 6 We arrived unexpectedly by the river. | We up by the river. |
| 7 I turned left instead of right. | I took the wrong . |

29.4 Complete the text.

I was on the ¹ *main* road into town today and I saw an ² .
 I was ³ a roundabout when the guy behind tried to ⁴ me and the driver in front of me. He was driving too fast – over the ⁵ limit – and he lost control of the car. He had to ⁶ to avoid a car on the other side of the road, and in the end he ⁷ into a tree. The car was badly ⁸ , but to my surprise, the man got out of the car with no ⁹ at all.

29.5 Over to you

Answer the questions about your own country. If possible, compare your answers with someone else.

- 1 Do you have a speed limit on motorways? If so, what is it?
- 2 How many lanes do motorways usually have?
- 3 Do drivers usually stop for pedestrians at pedestrian crossings? If not, why not?
- 4 Do many people park their cars on the pavements? Why? / Why not?